



q & a

Your Questions, Our Answers



All your computer niggles and nags are dealt with here!

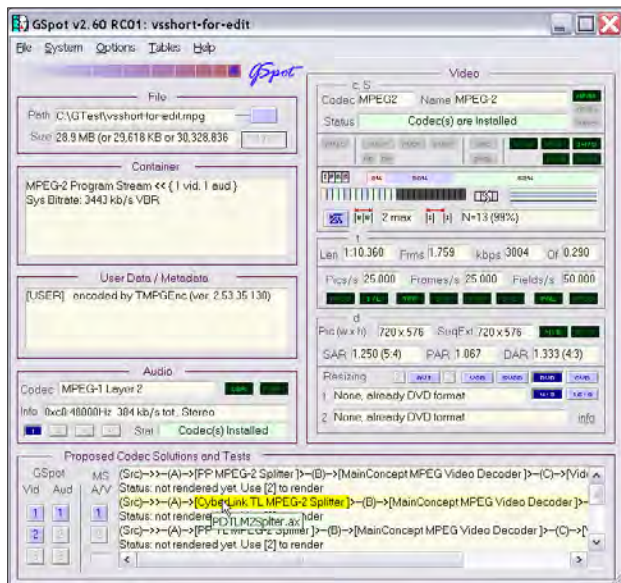
Q A couple of problems

1. I have a wired broadband connection on my PC connected through a normal ADSL2+ router, but it doesn't have Wi-Fi capabilities. Is there some way to share the internet bandwidth with the PC and my laptop. Also, can I play a game such as *Counter Strike* over LAN with both?
2. Can I use my old 80-GB hard drive as an external drive using some external casing? Is there a way to use it as a backup drive with XP?
3. Is there a way to see all the details of a video file and save some other video to that format? Can I put some other video that isn't recorded through my handycam into my handycam by converting that video to the handycams default format and by naming it in the sequence followed by my handycam. One of the ways for outputting the file was given in your Tips and Tricks section using the VLC transcoder.

Vishal Singh

A You will have to buy a separate router that accesses the ADSL2+ router to let you access the internet using the laptop and the PC. It will also allow you to play *Counter Strike* between the two PCs.

You can use old 80-GB hard drive as an external storage disk. Purchase a 3.5-inch casing for it. It shouldn't cost you more than Rs. 700 for a decent one. Make sure it has an interface for your drive before you do.



G-spot displays information on the format

Use a program called G-Spot to get details of the video format used by your camera. Often, manufacturers use proprietary or modified codecs within existing / known containers; hence, it might not work if you try and re-encode videos to the specific resolution and codec.

Q Major overheating problems!

My configuration is: AMD Athlon 64 x2 4200+, MSI motherboard with inbuilt NVIDIA 6100 graphics, 2 GB 667 MHz RAM, 250 GB Hard Disk. The drive has two partitions – one with Windows XP SP3 and



SMART is monitoring and analysing technology found in almost every hard drive today

TOOLBOX

other runs Windows Vista. When I use my computer for 3 to 4 hours at a time, it restarts due to overheating. When I check the BIOS, my system temperature shows up as 87 degrees. A few days ago, I discovered my PSU's fan wasn't moving, so I thought this could be the problem. Therefore, I changed my SMPS and bought an Intex 450-W SMPS, but the problem hasn't gone away. I cleaned my processor fan and RAM modules, but the condition has remained the same. I thought that it could be due to an infection so I ran a complete scan with Avast 2009 Home Edition with latest updates, but it didn't work either. My computer usually shuts down when I play games such as *Far Cry 2* or *Need for Speed Undercover*.

Bidyankur Bhagawati

A Your's certainly seems to be an overheating problem. Your CPU temperature is way too high. Install SpeedFan that lets you monitor your CPU temperature while running Windows. If cleaning doesn't help, try touching the metal heatsink immediately after powering off the system. If it feels really hot, then remove the heatsink and apply a new layer of thermal paste and reattach the heatsink. The existing paste might have dried up or your heatsink may not be properly thermally connected to the heatsink.

Q Connecting a new PC with Windows XP to a domain

I have bought a new PC with Windows XP Professional. I have a network with a domain setup. I want to know how to configure XP to connect to the network so that a user can login into the domain. I know how to configure Windows 98, but I'm not sure how it's done on Windows XP.

Rajesh Kumar

A Making your PC a part of the domain can be done by clicking on Start > Control Panel > System. Within the Computer Name tab, click on Change to rename the PC name or set a workgroup or domain. Choose to be a member of a domain instead of a workgroup.

Q DOS window problem

I have a Dell XPS M1530 laptop running on Windows Vista Home Premium SP1. Whenever I type ipconfig in Start > Run, the window opens for a brief second and then closes immediately. The same problem occurs when I run some DOS programs. What can I do? The problem does not arise when I open command prompt and then type ipconfig. This doesn't occur on my PC running on XP SP2.

Roy Fernandez

A Command prompts accessed through Start > Run automatically shut once the execution of the command is completed. Using Start > Run > cmd and pressing [Enter] might be the simplest way to start your command line applications. If commands such as ipconfig are required to be run very often, then you can create a batch file in notepad with the following text.

```
cmd
ipconfig
Save the file as a BAT file and run it when you need it.
```

Q Strange errors in Windows

My PC configuration is as follows:

Processor: Intel Core Duo CPU E7200

Motherboard: ASUS P5GCMX-1333 I am using Windows Vista as my OS.

My computer has a couple of problems.

1. During start up, it shows up errors that say "Rundll32 not found".
2. I am unable to run Task manager. It says "Disabled by administrator".